

UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX

Undergraduate Examinations 2020

Current Disputes in Sociology: Sociological Analysis III

Time allowed: 24 hours

Please see your exam timetable or check on FASER for the deadline to upload your answer.

The times shown on your timetable are in British Summer Time (BST). Please check online for a conversion to your local time if you will be undertaking your assessment outside the United Kingdom

INSTRUCTIONS

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions in total: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B**, and **ONE** from either **SECTION A** or **SECTION B**.

The paper consists of **SEVENTEEN** questions in total

All questions are of equal weight.

You may write up to 2250 words for this paper, a suggested 750 per question.

These questions have been set so that you can answer them within the normal exam time frame which is three hours. You are not expected to spend 24 hours on this assessment.

Referencing and plagiarism

You may consult resources for this take-home exam. You are NOT expected to provide a bibliography.

You must avoid copying from text books, articles, online sources or your own previous work. If you do quote, you must use quotation marks and provide in-text references. Penalties for plagiarism will apply.

You are reminded that collaborating with other students is collusion, which is also an academic offence. Penalties will apply.

Submission

If you have a query with the content of this exam paper contact socugrad@essex.ac.uk

If you have a technical problem with FASER, or any other query, please go to [Exams Website](#) to find contact details of the teams that can help you.

Please note that the time allocated for this assessment includes time for you to download this question and answer paper and to upload your question and answers paper to FASER.

Please allow at least 30 minutes at the end of your exam time to upload your work. Once you have completed the assessment do not leave it to the last minute to upload.

Please save your work throughout the examination to avoid losing your work. **You must only submit Microsoft Word documents.**

Please do not communicate with any other candidate in any way during this assessment. Your response must be your own work. Procedures are in place to detect plagiarism and collusion.

Candidates must answer THREE questions in total: one from Section A, one from Section B, and one from either Section A or Section B.

SECTION A

1. Is sociology a science?
2. Outline and assess the neo-Kantian approach to sociology.
3. Is modernity a Eurocentric concept?
4. How effective is Barthes' semiological approach for analysing contemporary society?
5. Outline and assess Bourdieu's concept of "habitus". How useful is this for analysing social inequality today?
6. Is experience a legitimate basis for developing knowledge claims about the social world?
7. Critically analyse different feminist epistemologies' accounts of the relationship between gender and knowledge.
8. Critically examine the ways in which sociologists have analysed global inequality.
9. Outline and assess why sociologists need to analyse language in order to better understand the social world.

END OF SECTION A

Candidates must answer THREE questions in total: one from Section A, one from Section B, and one from either Section A or Section B.

SECTION B

10. Is contemporary society a disciplinary society?
11. What is distinctive about Foucault's understanding of the relation between power and statistics?
12. How does Du Bois challenge Enlightenment conceptions of race?
13. Outline and assess Said's concept of "Orientalism".
14. What is meant by the term "the male gaze"? How can it help us think about the world today?
15. Can sociologists analyse the body without falling back into essentialism?
16. "Binary definitions of 'man' and 'woman' are limited and limiting." Critically analyse this statement.
17. Outline and assess the limitations of basing sociology on the study of only humans.

END OF SECTION B

**END OF QUESTION PAPER
PLEASE SEE NEXT PAGE FOR THE ANSWER SHEET**

ANSWER SHEET
(Please use as many sheets as you need to)

Student Registration Number:

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TYPE THE QUESTION NUMBERS AND YOUR ANSWERS HERE: